

“There are no ‘road maps’ or rigid rules when it comes to Linux”

With more than two decades of history, the Linux kernel is one of the biggest and fastest developing open source projects, with about 53,600 files and around 20 million lines of code. To understand the story of Linux better and to learn about future open source technologies, Ankita K.S. from OSFY interacted with Kaiwan N. Billimoria, proprietor of kaiwanTECH and author of the book, ‘Hands-On System Programming with Linux’.



Kaiwan N. Billimoria, proprietor, kaiwanTECH

Q What technologies are Indian developers focusing on?

Many developers are now diving into what is considered by pundits as the 'hot and exciting' technologies — machine learning (ML), artificial intelligence (AI), VR, and possibly, blockchain and industrial IoT, would top this list. However, in all the excitement over the 'latest and greatest', it should not be forgotten that certain

fundamental 'old' technologies continue to be the ones critical for business and academia. To deviate a bit, I find that many freshers nowadays focus on Web technologies, Java, along with ML and AI to some extent. While this is good, especially for young talent, it is also important not to lose sight of the fundamentals of how computer and software engineering works at the 'bare metal' level, as it were. Focusing on infrastructure technologies, operating systems (OS), low-level and systems programming (and even the hardware, to some extent) is very important to ensure a strong career in technology.

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Q Is industry welcoming open source with open arms?

Yes, of course. Open source is now no longer seen as something very new and radical. Industry acceptance is growing rapidly. Having said that, there are also players who delay and adopt a 'let's wait and watch' approach, possibly analysing the risks. But most companies have already realised that open source is now a mature and key part of the software ecosystem. So adopting it, or perhaps gently phasing it in, is something that must occur.